

Don Stevenson

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SUMMARY

Front-end-focused full-stack engineer with 6+ years shipping production React applications, including hands-on Next.js App Router work and Tailwind CSS component-driven UI. Experienced working from existing design direction and specs to close the gap between intended design and shipped UI, and comfortable improving inherited or fast-built front-end code without slowing feature delivery. Has repeatedly paired with backend-owned APIs and design leads on short, focused engagements rather than working solo on greenfield builds.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front-End: React (Hooks), TypeScript (strict mode), Next.js (App Router & Pages Router), Tailwind CSS, component-driven UI architecture, responsive/mobile-first design

Design Implementation: Translating design specs and mockups into pixel-accurate UI, empty/error/loading state design, visual QA and regression fixes

Integrations: Third-party API and widget integration (Google Maps API, Contentful CMS, reCAPTCHA v3), REST APIs, real-time UI (Socket.io)

Backend & Data: Node.js, Express, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Firestore

Testing & Quality: Playwright (E2E), React Testing Library, Cucumber, Jest, unit test coverage strategy

Collaboration: Agile/Scrum, pairing with backend engineers and design leads, async collaboration, code review, Git

EXPERIENCE

Volunteer Tech Lead & Full-Stack Developer, LandSeed

Oct 2025 – Present

Housing-development platform connecting landowners with Canadians seeking housing (MERN stack)

- Designed and shipped the LandMatch marketing landing page on Next.js App Router, backed by Firestore and Upstash Redis and deployed on Vercel, with reCAPTCHA v3 for spam protection.
- Took over an existing, fast-moving codebase and raised unit test coverage from ~45% to 82%, standing up a Playwright E2E suite in GitHub Actions CI to catch visual and functional regressions before staging.
- Migrated legacy express-validator logic to Zod schema validation and added request-level rate limiting, tightening the reliability of the API layer the front end depends on.
- Reviewed and cleaned up teammates' UI pull requests as tech lead, catching inconsistencies between shipped components and intended behavior before merge.

Full-Stack Agile Software Engineer, TribalScale

Dec 2021 – May 2025

Digital consultancy delivering short, focused engagements for enterprise clients including Ford and Manulife

- Built driver, pharmacy, and task-management interfaces for ScriptRunner in React and Tailwind CSS, working from existing design direction and pairing closely with backend engineers on API contracts.
- Led the migration of the company marketing site from Gatsby to Next.js with Contentful CMS, untangling an older component structure into a cleaner, more maintainable layer without pausing content updates.
- Delivered features for Manulife Canada's customer-facing banking frontend in React, backed by React Testing Library and Cucumber E2E coverage, in a fast-moving, design-led environment.
- Built the React frontend for a fleet repair management application used by Ford USA and Ford Europe, matching a shared design system across markets with different operational workflows.
- Built a full-stack crypto trading platform (Ebox) with a React/TypeScript/Tailwind frontend on a Laravel/PHP backend, taking ownership of UI fidelity against provided designs.
- Rotated across multiple short client engagements rather than one long build, developing a fast onboarding habit: read the existing codebase, find where implementation drifted from design, and fix it without a rewrite.

Full-Stack Developer, Harbourfront Centre

Apr 2021 – Sep 2021

Contract — led the rebuild and launch of harbourfrontcentre.com

- Led the front-end rebuild of the organization's flagship public website, working directly with the design team to translate creative direction into a cohesive, high-fidelity site.
- Introduced Git-based version control, automated testing, and CI/CD practices to a team that previously lacked them, mentoring other developers through the transition.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Frontend Web Developer, Sebastian Knox Woodwind Services (2020–Present, contract): migrated a client e-commerce site to Shopify, building custom Liquid/JavaScript UI features (+20% sales) and a GitHub-based CI/CD pipeline with automated unit and E2E tests.
- Full-Stack Developer (2024- Present): NextJs application for a soccer league to create balanced teams 3 times per week; serving 200+ players in the GTA
- Full-Stack Developer Mentor & Project Evaluator, Lighthouse Labs (2021): mentored bootcamp students in full-stack JavaScript fundamentals and evaluated capstone projects.

EDUCATION

Web Development, Lighthouse Labs — Toronto, ON

B.Ed., Science & Instrumental Music, University of Toronto — Toronto, ON